



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "does free will explain all evil?" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

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We've now discussed the main challenges to the free will defense, which is
the most important response to the argument from evil.

You should separate out two questions. First, can free will explain the existence of some evil? Second, just how much can it explain?

Can free will, or free will plus some other assumptions, make it reasonable to believe in God despite the kinds of evil we find in the world?

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Summing up so far: we have seen that Frege will promise to explain how

God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good

the ability
to harm others
is a great good

**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can explain some evil; but it can't explain all of the evil we find in the world.

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